

Chapter 4 — Jñāna-Karma-Sannyāsa Yoga

ज्ञानकर्मसंन्यासयोगः : జ్ఞానకర్మసన్యాసయోగము

"The Yoga of Knowledge & Renunciation of Action" · 42 verses · Action illumined by wisdom

Chapter 4 introduces the **third pillar** — **jñāna (knowledge)** — and shows how it weaves together with karma. Kṛṣṇa reveals that this same teaching is **eternal**, transmitted from sage to sage in an unbroken lineage. He declares the principle of **avatāra** — the Divine's repeated descent into the world to restore *dharma* — and teaches the great paradox: "He who sees inaction in action, and action in inaction — he is the wise one among men."

Detailed sheet already exists for the most famous passage:

• [yada yada.html](#) — full word-by-word for BG 4.7 & 4.8 (*yadā yadā hi dharmasya + paritrāṇāya sādhuṇām*) — the principle of *avatāra*.

Other essential verses of Chapter 4

BG 4.18 The wise see inaction in action and action in inaction

कर्मण्यकर्म यः पश्येदकर्मणि च कर्म यः ।

स बुद्धिमान्मनुष्येषु स युक्तः कृत्स्नकर्मकृत् ॥ ४.१८ ॥

కర్మణ్యకర్మ యః పశ్యేదకర్మణి చ కర్మ యః ।

స బుద్ధిమాన్మనుష్యేషు స యుక్తః కృత్స్నకర్మకృత్ ॥ ౪.౧౮ ॥

karmaṇy akarma yaḥ paśyed akarmaṇi ca karma yaḥ |

sa buddhimān manuṣyeṣu sa yuktaḥ kṛtsna-karma-kṛt | |

"One who sees inaction in action, and action in inaction —
that one is wise among men, established in yoga, doing all action."

The paradox: external work done with inner stillness is *true* action; external stillness with inner agitation is *not*.

BG 4.34 The method of learning — approach a teacher with humility and questioning

तद्विद्धि प्रणिपातेन परिप्रश्नेन सेवया ।

उपदेक्ष्यन्ति ते ज्ञानं ज्ञानिनस्तत्त्वदर्शिनः ॥ ४.३४ ॥

తద్విద్ధి ప్రణిపాతేన పరిప్రశ్నేన సేవయా ।

ఉపదేక్ష్యంతి తే జ్ఞానం జ్ఞానినస్తత్త్వదర్శినః ॥ ౪.౩౪ ॥

tad viddhi praṇipātena paripraśnena sevayā |

upadekṣyanti te jñānaṁ jñāninastattva-darśinaḥ | |

"Know this by approaching the wise with prostration,
with sincere inquiry, and with service.
Those who have seen the truth will instruct you in knowledge."
The classic verse on *guru-paramparā* — the spiritual relationship.

Word-by-Word — 4.34 (how to learn)

IAST	तत्त्व	विद्धि	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>tat viddhi</i>	तद् विद्धि	तद् विद्धि	tad VID-dhi	know that
<i>praṇipātena</i>	प्रणिपातेन	प्रणिपातेन	pra-ni-PAA-te-na	by prostration, humble approach
<i>paripraśnena</i>	परिप्रश्नेन	परिप्रश्नेन	pa-ri-PRASH-ne-na	by thorough questioning, sincere inquiry
<i>sevayā</i>	सेवया	सेवया	SE-va-yaa	by service
<i>upadekṣyanti</i>	उपदेक्ष्यन्ति	उपदेक्ष्यन्ति	u-pa-DEK-shyan-ti	they will instruct, teach
<i>te</i>	ते	ते	te	to you

